i) **Glass containers:** Glass containers are heavy and fragile but glass is still predominantly used as a packaging medium for a number of processed food items like carbonated beverages, syrups, squashes, jams, jellies, pickles, malted-milk foods, instant coffee, sauces, ketchup etc. Glass is preferred as it is inert and resistant product visibility. It offers additional benefits of impermeability, reusability and recyclability.

ii) **Metal containers:** Tinplate containers are available in wide range of capacities. Inner lacquer coating is essential for tin plate containers which should be compatible with the food product. Metal drums and used for bulk packaging. Because of the superior strength and excellent protection tin plate containers are used for a variety of processed food items like cheese, baby foods and milk powder, biscuits, processed fruits and vegetables, jams, meat and fish preparations, edible oils etc.

iii) **Composite containers:** In composite containers, generally, the body is made up of paperboard tubes and the ends are made up of metal. The body of the container is lined internally with plastic films or aluminum foil. Food products like spices, custard powder, and corn flour are packed in composite containers.

iv) **Wooden crates or boxes:** Wooden crates are used extensively for weight above 100 kg.

v) **Plastic:** Polystyrene is principally made into tubs for ice-creams, small packages for butter, jam and cheese. Recycled plastic is not to be used for storing food grains. Biscuits stay crackling fresh mouths on end and cakes retain their softness even after weeks due to tough cellophane packages.

vi) **Modified atmosphere packaging/ Gas flushing:** These are packaging methods for extending the life of food products by changing the atmosphere surrounding the food inside the package.

a. In modified atmosphere packaging, the gas mix (carbon dioxide, nitrogen, oxygen) inside the package, suppresses / aggravates naturally occurring reactions of food. This method is employed for highly perishable food like meat, meat products.



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